

TEACH

1. Passage anchor

The passage does not use the bare verb **teach** in a target sentence, but it is directly represented by the family member:

> “my secondary school English **teacher**, Mrs. Chan”

and by the description of what she did in class.

Passage meaning

teach = help someone learn knowledge, a skill, or a subject, usually by explaining, showing, guiding, or giving practice

教 ; 教導 ; 教授

In this passage, Mrs. Chan did more than transfer knowledge. She also guided the speaker's confidence and mindset.

Practice

1. She **taught me English** for two years.

她**教了我兩年英文**。

2. A good teacher does more than **teach a subject**; they can also shape how students think.

好老師不只是**教授科目**，也可能影響學生的思考方式。

Core meanings of TEACH

2. teach — give instruction in a subject or skill

= help someone learn a subject, skill, or activity

教 ; 教授 ; 教導

Examples

1. She **teaches English** at a secondary school.

她在中學**教英文**。

2. My father **taught me how to cook**.

我爸爸**教我怎麼做飯**。

This is the central meaning.

3. teach someone something

= give a person knowledge or skill in a particular area

****教某人某事****

Examples

1. She ****taught us grammar****.

她****教我們文法****。

2. He ****taught the children basic safety rules****.

他****教孩子們基本安全規則****。

Very high-value pattern.

4. teach something to someone

= teach a subject, idea, or skill to a person

****把.....教給某人****

Examples

1. She ****taught English to adult learners****.

她****教成人學習者英文****。

2. The course ****teaches basic coding to beginners****.

這門課****教初學者基礎程式設計****。

5. teach someone to do something

= train or instruct someone so they learn how to perform an action

****教某人做.....****

Examples

1. My mother ****taught me to swim****.

我媽媽****教我游泳****。

2. The coach ****taught the players to stay calm under pressure****.

教練**教球員在壓力下保持冷靜**。

6. teach someone how to do something

= show or explain the method for doing something

教某人如何做.....

Examples

1. Can you **teach me how to use this software**?

你可以**教我怎麼使用這套軟體**嗎？

2. She **taught us how to structure an essay**.

她**教我們如何組織一篇文章**。

Teaching a subject / course

7. teach a subject

= be responsible for giving lessons in a particular academic subject

教授某科；教某科

Examples

1. He **teaches mathematics**.

他**教數學**。

2. She has **taught history** for ten years.

她已經**教歷史十年了**。

8. teach a class / course

= be the instructor responsible for a particular class or course

教某班；教授某課程

Examples

1. She **teaches three classes** every morning.

她每天早上**教三個班**。

2. He **teaches a course on modern literature**.

他**教授一門現代文學課程**。

Here, the object refers to the teaching assignment rather than the content itself.

Work as a teacher

9. teach — work as a teacher

= have teaching as your job

任教；當老師

Examples

1. She **teaches at a local school**.

她在當地一所學校**任教**。

2. He **taught for twenty years** before retiring.

他退休前**教了二十年書**。

No direct object is required here.

10. teach at / in

= work as a teacher at a particular institution or in a place

在……任教

Examples

1. She **teaches at a university**.

她在大學**任教**。

2. He **taught in Japan** for several years.

他曾在日本**教書**好幾年。

Cause someone to learn from experience

11. teach — cause someone to learn a lesson from experience

= make someone understand something through an experience

****使.....學到；讓.....明白****

Examples

1. The experience ****taught me patience****.

那段經歷****教會了我耐心****。

2. Failure ****taught him an important lesson****.

失敗****讓他學到了一個重要教訓****。

This is a major figurative extension.

12. teach someone a lesson

This has two important uses.

A. help someone learn something important

****讓某人得到教訓 / 學到一課****

1. The mistake ****taught me a valuable lesson****.

那次錯誤****讓我學到寶貴的一課****。

2. The experience ****taught her a lesson about trust****.

那段經歷****讓她在信任這件事上學到教訓****。

B. punish someone so they will not repeat bad behavior

****給某人一個教訓****

1. He wanted to ****teach them a lesson****.

他想****給他們一個教訓****。

2. The fine was meant to ****teach him a lesson****.

那筆罰款是想****給他一個教訓****。

Context determines whether the phrase is educational or punitive.

Influence values / behavior

13. teach someone values / habits / behavior

= help someone develop principles, habits, or ways of behaving

****教導某人價值觀 / 習慣 / 行為方式****

Examples

1. Parents ****teach children respect**** through both words and actions.

父母會透過言語和行動****教孩子尊重他人****。

2. Sport can ****teach young people discipline****.

運動可以****教會年輕人自律****。

This overlaps with “cause to learn,” but is very common.

Information / principle

14. teach that...

= communicate or promote a principle, belief, or doctrine

****教導..... ; 主張.....****

Examples

1. The course ****teaches that communication is a two-way process****.

這門課****教導溝通是雙向的過程****。

2. Many traditions ****teach that patience is a virtue****.

許多傳統****教導耐心是一種美德****。

Nature / experience as teacher

15. experience teaches...

= experience shows or demonstrates a truth

****經驗告訴我們；經驗使人明白****

Examples

1. Experience ****teaches us that preparation matters****.

經驗****告訴我們準備很重要****。

2. History ****teaches us that change is rarely simple****.

歷史****讓我們明白改變很少是簡單的****。

The subject need not be a person.

Idiomatic / extended uses

16. teach yourself

= learn something without a formal teacher

自學；自己學會

Examples

1. She **taught herself Spanish**.

她**自學西班牙文**。

2. He **taught himself to code**.

他**自學程式設計**。

17. teach yourself to do something

= deliberately train yourself to develop a skill or habit

訓練自己做.....；自學.....

Examples

1. I **taught myself to speak more slowly**.

我**訓練自己說慢一點**。

2. She **taught herself to stay calm during interviews**.

她**訓練自己在面試時保持冷靜**。

18. that'll teach you / that'll teach someone

= informal expression meaning an unpleasant consequence should make someone avoid repeating an action

這下得到教訓了吧；看你下次還敢不敢

Examples

1. "I forgot my umbrella and got soaked." "Well, **that'll teach you**."

「我忘了帶傘，淋得全身濕透。」 「**這下得到教訓了吧。**」

2. The embarrassing mistake **taught him not to rush**.

那次尷尬的錯誤**讓他學會不要急躁**。

The fixed expression can sound teasing or unsympathetic, depending on tone.

19. you can't teach an old dog new tricks

= proverb meaning it can be difficult to make someone change long-established habits

老狗學不了新把戲；積習難改

Examples

1. He refuses to use the new system—**you can't teach an old dog new tricks**, as they say.

他不肯用新系統——正所謂**積習難改**。

2. The saying does not literally mean older people cannot learn.

這句諺語並不是字面上說年長者不能學習。

This is a proverb, not a core lexical sense.

Related forms

20. teacher

= person whose job or role is to teach

老師；教師

Examples

1. She is an English **teacher**.

她是一位英文**老師**。

2. A good **teacher** can influence students far beyond the classroom.

好**老師**的影響可以遠超出課堂。

This is the passage's explicit family form.

21. teaching — activity or profession

= the work or profession of teaching

****教學；教職****

Examples

1. She has worked in ****teaching**** for many years.
她從事****教學工作****多年。
2. Good ****teaching**** requires patience and clarity.
良好的****教學****需要耐心和清晰表達。

22. teaching — doctrine / principle

Plural or countable in some contexts:

= a principle or set of beliefs taught by a religion, philosopher, movement, etc.

****教義；教導****

Examples

1. The book discusses Buddhist ****teachings****.
這本書討論佛教****教義****。
2. His ****teachings**** influenced later thinkers.
他的****思想教導****影響了後來的思想家。

This is distinct from “teaching” as the profession.

23. teachable

A. able or willing to learn

****可教的；願意學習的****

B. capable of being taught

****可教授的****

Examples

1. Curiosity and openness make someone more ****teachable****.

好奇與開放的態度會讓人更**願意學習**。

2. Some skills are easier to make explicit and **teachable** than others.
有些技能比其他技能更容易被整理成**可教授的內容**。

24. teachable moment

= situation that naturally provides a good opportunity for learning
適合教育 / 教學的時機；教育契機

Examples

1. The mistake became a **teachable moment**.
那次錯誤變成了一個很好的**教育契機**。
2. Good teachers recognize **teachable moments**.
好老師懂得把握**適合教學的時機**。

Very useful modern expression.

Grammar patterns

25. teach + person + thing

> She **taught me English**.

= **她教我英文。 **

Structure:

teach + learner + content

26. teach + thing + to + person

> She **taught English to us**.

= **她教我們英文。 **

Structure:

****teach + content + to + learner****

Usually less natural than ****teach us English**** when both patterns are possible.

27. teach + person + to-infinitive

> She ****taught me to speak confidently****.

= ****她教我更有自信地說話。****

28. teach + person + how to...

> She ****taught me how to organize my ideas****.

= ****她教我如何整理自己的想法。****

29. teach + subject / class / course

* teach English

* teach a class

* teach a course

These objects are related but not identical:

* ****English**** = subject/content

* ****a class**** = group/teaching session

* ****a course**** = organized programme of study

Important usage note

30. teach vs learn

A very common learner error:

****teach****

= cause/help another person to learn

****教****

****learn****

= gain knowledge or skill

****學；學會****

Compare:

> She ****taught me English****.

> 她教我英文。

> I ****learned English from her****.

> 我跟她學英文。

Not:

> *She learned me English.* ❌

Key contrasts

31. teach vs instruct

****teach****

= broad everyday word for helping someone learn

****教；教導****

****instruct****

= give formal, systematic, or specific directions/instruction

****教授；指示****

Compare:

> She ****teaches English****.

> 她教英文。

> Staff were ****instructed to leave the building****.

> 員工被****指示離開大樓****。

****Instruct**** can mean “give orders,” where ****teach**** cannot.

32. teach vs train

****teach****

= give knowledge or help someone learn a subject or skill

****train****

= systematically develop ability through repeated practice, especially for a job, sport, or specific performance

****訓練****

Compare:

> She ****taught me the basic technique****.

> 她教我基本技巧。

> The coach ****trained me for the competition****.

> 教練訓練我參加比賽。

33. teach vs educate

****educate****

= provide broader intellectual, moral, or systematic education

****教育****

****teach****

= directly help someone learn particular knowledge or skills

****教****

Compare:

> Schools ****educate children****.

> 學校教育兒童。

> Teachers ****teach children mathematics****.

> 老師教孩子數學。

34. teach vs show

****show someone how to do something****

= demonstrate the method

****teach someone how to do something****

= help them actually learn the skill

Compare:

> He **showed** me how to use the machine.

> 他示範給我看機器怎麼用。

> He **taught** me how to use the machine properly.

> 他教會我如何正確使用機器。

Teaching usually implies more sustained learning than simply showing.

35. teach vs tell

tell

= give information

告訴

teach

= help someone learn and retain knowledge or skill

教

Compare:

> She **told** me the answer.

> 她告訴我答案。

> She **taught** me how to find the answer.

> 她教我怎麼找到答案。

This distinction fits the passage especially well: Mrs. Chan did not merely tell students what was wrong; she helped them learn how to improve.

Meaning map

The central concept of **teach** is:

cause or help someone to learn

From this develop:

Academic instruction

teach English

→ **教英文**

Skill instruction

teach someone to swim

→ **教某人游泳**

Profession

teach at a school

→ **任教**

Experience

failure taught me a lesson

→ **使我學到教訓**

Values

teach children respect

→ **教導價值觀**

Principles

a tradition teaches that...

→ **教導 / 主張**

Self-learning

teach yourself

→ **自學**

Family

teacher

→ **教師**

teaching

→ **教學；教義**

The passage mainly belongs to the first and broader guidance branches:

teacher

→ someone who helps students learn

and, figuratively,

her influence taught the speaker a healthier way to think about communication and confidence.

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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teach — general instruction	幫助某人學會知識、技能或科目；教 / 教導
teach someone something	把某項知識、內容或技能教給某人
teach something to someone	向某人教授某項知識或技能
teach someone to do something	教某人學會做某個動作或技能
teach someone how to do something	解釋並訓練某人掌握某種做法
teach a subject	在學校或其他場合教授某一學科
teach a class/course	負責某班級或課程的教學
teach — profession	以教師身分任教 / 從事教學工作
teach at/in	在某學校、機構或地方任教
experience teaches someone something	某段經歷使人領悟或學會某件事
teach someone a lesson — learning	使某人從經驗中得到重要教訓
teach someone a lesson — punishment	透過懲罰讓某人記取教訓
teach values/behavior	教導某人形成某種價值觀、習慣或行為方式
teach that...	傳授或主張某個原則、信念或觀念
teach yourself	不依靠正式老師而自己學會；自學
teacher	負責教導學生的人；老師 / 教師
teaching — profession/activity	教授知識或技能的工作 / 教學
teachings	某宗教、哲學家或思想體系所傳授的教義 / 思想
teachable	願意學習的；能被教授的
teachable moment	自然出現、適合用來引導學習的教育契機

Passage recap

The passage directly contains the family member:

> “my secondary school English **teacher**”

and repeatedly describes how Mrs. Chan guided the speaker’s learning.

Here:

teach = **help a student learn knowledge, skills, and ways of thinking**

Best Traditional Chinese renderings:

* **教**

* **教導**

* **教授**

* depending on context: **教會**

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

teach

= **help someone acquire knowledge, understanding, or a skill through instruction or guidance**

教；教導；教授

The key learner distinction is:

* **teach** → 老師 / 他人「教」

* **learn** → 學習者「學」

> Mrs. Chan **taught** me English.

> 陳老師**教**我英文。

> I **learned** English from Mrs. Chan.

> 我跟陳老師**學**英文。